

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 34 Handout — Staging is a dressing room. Swap is a VIP flip. F1 has no room — Standard S1+ does

4 - Continuous Delivery · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — slots on Microsoft.Web/sites (App Service)

Piece	What it is	YAML / portal
Production slot	The default site hostname	appName only; slot not set
Staging slot	Microsoft.Web/sites/slots name staging	Portal: Deployment slots → Add or deployToSlotOrASE
Swap	VIP / hostname flip; instances stay warm if you warmed them	az webapp deployment slot swap
Slot setting	Sticky app setting (slotSetting: true)	Does not ride the swap — connection strings, flags
Warm-up	applicationInitialization / hit staging URL	Swap of a cold process is a scheduled brownout

Architecture B — SKU gate (do not fake the lab)

SKU	Slots?	What to do today
F1 / D1 / Shared	No	Write the warm-up path + SKU note. Do not claim swap
B1 Basic	No slots on Basic	Same — document, or bump to S1 for a short lab
S1 Standard / P*	Yes (staging + more on higher)	Create staging, deploy, smoke, swap, swap back
Functions Consumption	Not the App Service slot story	Premium/Dedicated Functions if you need slots

Architecture C — pitfalls that swap the wrong outfit

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
No sticky settings	Staging DB URL becomes production's	Mark secrets/flags as slot settings before swap
Skip warm-up	First users after swap hit cold start / 503	Hit staging until ready; then swap
Auto-swap on	Every staging deploy flips prod	Off until smoke is a real check, not a glance
Deploy to production slot	You never used the dressing room	AzureWebApp@1 deployToSlotOrASE: true slot: staging

One-liner to remember

Slots are dressing rooms for production — try the outfit on, warm it, then walk the runway. Swap back if it rips.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal subscription + personal org. Slots need Standard S1+ (not F1). If you will not spend, the document still ships.

- 1 Portal → your web app → Deployment slots. If Add is disabled, you are on F1/Basic. Record the SKU. Do not lie that you swapped.
- 2 If you bump: az appservice plan update --sku S1 (short window). Create slot staging. Remember S1 costs — delete same night.
- 3 Deploy the same drop to staging (deployToSlotOrASE + resourceName: staging). Do not rebuild.
- 4 Smoke the staging URL (default hostname <slot>.azurewebsites.net). Hit it until the app is actually up.

- 5 az webapp deployment slot swap -g <rg> -n <app> --slot staging --target-slot production. Confirm production URL. Swap back once (rollback practice).
- 6 Write docs/slots-warmup-day34.md: warm-up path, sticky settings, auto-swap = off. Include 'SKU blocked slots' if it did.

Deploy to staging + swap (S1+ only)

```
- task: AzureWebApp@1
  inputs:
    azureSubscription: azure-100-sc
    appName: app-day32-<unique>
    deployToSlotOrASE: true
    resourceGroupName: rg-day32-lab
    slotName: staging
    package: $(Pipeline.Workspace)/ci/drop/**/*.*.zip

# after smoke on https://app-day32-<unique>-staging.azurewebsites.net
az webapp deployment slot swap -g rg-day32-lab -n app-day32-<unique> \
  --slot staging --target-slot production
```

Done checklist

- Know F1 has no slots; S1+ does
- Warm-up path written even if SKU blocked the lab
- If you swapped: you also swapped back once
- S1 plan not left running overnight without a reason

Tomorrow — Day 35

Blue-green — two worlds, one traffic pointer. On App Service that map is prod slot + staging.